

Prenatal Care Overview

Prenatal care is the scheduled medical follow-up that runs from the first positive pregnancy test through birth. Regular visits let a clinician track growth, blood pressure, and the parent's wellbeing.

A typical schedule in an uncomplicated pregnancy is a first visit in the first trimester, monthly visits until 28 weeks, fortnightly visits until 36 weeks, and weekly visits thereafter. Local services may differ.

Warning signs that need same-day medical attention include vaginal bleeding, sudden severe headache, visual disturbance, severe abdominal pain, reduced fetal movements after 24 weeks, and a fever that does not settle.

Each visit commonly includes blood pressure, urine testing for protein, measurement of the uterus, and a conversation about mood, sleep, and support at home. Blood tests may check anaemia, blood group, and immunity.

This overview does not describe drug treatment or emergency procedures. It exists so patients know what routine care looks like and when to seek help.